

Minestrone

Olive oil

1 brown onion, chopped finely

1 clove garlic, crushed

1 large carrot, diced

3 sticks celery, sliced

1 large zucchini, diced

1 chicken stock cube (or vegetable stock for vegetarians)

1 x 170 g can tomato paste

2 x 400 g cans crushed tomatoes with Italian herbs

1 cup (180 g) macaroni, fusilli or any small pasta

1 x 400 g can four-bean mix, rinsed and drained

Bunch of fresh parsley, torn

Heat oil in a saucepan over a medium heat. Fry onion and garlic until onion is translucent, then add the vegetables – first carrot, then celery and zucchini – and sweat on a low heat until soft. Boil the kettle and make 1 litre of chicken stock with stock cube; add to pan along with tomato paste. Pour in crushed tomatoes and add extra water, if you wish, to dilute to taste. Bring to the boil, add pasta and cook until al dente. Add beans and stir to heat through. Serve with parsley.

Serves 6. Cost per serve: \$3.75